First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

**Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here*.**

FIRST CONGREGATIONAL CHURCH VISION STATEMENT

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

FIRST CONGREGATIONAL CHURCH MISSION STATEMENT

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

**Please feel free to contact us:**
Administrative Office: 8 AM to 11 AM weekdays.
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: T-W-F, 9am-12pm
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent, pastoral matters outside of regular office hours, call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

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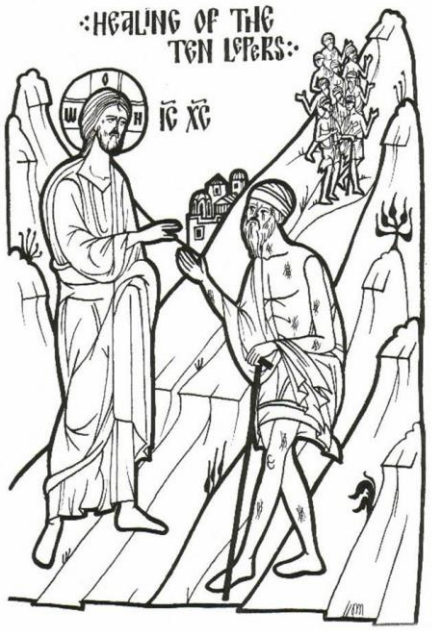
**OUR WORSHIP SERVICE** IS BROADCAST OVER THE LOCAL PUBLIC ACCESS CHANNEL 1079 ON SUNDAYS AT 4 PM.

**SCRIPTURE READER:** Doug Klette

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.




***"WE WELCOME YOU AND SERVE ALL THROUGH FAITH."***

***WORSHIP WITH US:***

***OCTOBER 9, 2022***

***10AM***

*REV. JESSICA MOORE, PASTOR*
*ERIN GRAINGER, MUSIC AND CHORAL DIRECTOR*
*STEPHAN CONRADY, ORGANIST*
*SUE POWERS, ADMINISTRATIVE ASSISTANT*
*27 CHURCH STREET, ST. ALBANS, VT 05478*
*802-524-4555*

*INFO@FIRSTCONGREGATIONALSTALBANS.ORG*
*WWW.FIRSTCONGREGATIONALSTALBANS.ORG*

## *WE GATHER AS GOD'S PEOPLE*

CENTERING WORDS**:**
"Where mercy, love, and pity dwell, there God is dwelling too.
– William Blake

### THE PREPARATION

*The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.*

PRELUDE

WELCOME AND ANNOUNCEMENTS

CALL TO WORSHIP: **TAIZÉ**




**Welcome to all visitors:** We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!
If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).
If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

**After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.**

*PLEASE STAND IF YOU ARE ABLE

[1]UCC, WORSHIP WAYS

MUSIC, COPYRIGHT PERMISSIONS: CCLI #4799426 AND SJMP #14586

**Announcements Continued**

**Special Collection for the FREE STORE at the food-shelf!**

Are you doing a fall cleaning? Is it time to declutter? If so, we are collecting clothes, housewares, linens, etc. for the FREE STORE at Northwest Family Foods food-shelf. We are collecting during the month of October. You can drop off your donations on Sunday or anytime the office is open (M-F; 8am-11am).

**A Night of Peaceful Protest Music!**

**Saturday November 5 from 7-9pm**

Open Mic - Coffee House. Sing-a-long to your favorite protest and peace music. See Greg Beeman or call the office for more details.

**Walking the Walk Fall Session**

**The Importance of Sabbath: It's all about rest!**

November 5th, 12th, and 19th 10 AM to noon here at First Congregational Church Join Pastors Jessica, Janet, and Darcy for our fall session of Walking the Walk! Our focus is on Sabbath and the Biblical imperative for rest-- from the final day of Creation to Jubilee to Jesus' need for alone time to pray. The Bible is clear, we need rest-- so why is it so difficult for us to take the time?

**Sunday October 16: Church Work Project**

On Sunday October 16th at 10am we'll be meeting for a short prayer service over coffee. After coffee we'll get to work! Organizing the basement, sprucing up the kitchen, etc. Please join us as we make our beautiful space more usable!

**Music Notes**: The entire fall season is one of stewardship, changing seasons, and of thanksgiving. This weekend, our Canadian neighbours celebrate harvest season with their Thanksgiving holiday.

Special thanks to visiting Canadian Pat Grainger for her participation in the service music this morning.

MORNING PRAYER[1]

Holy Love, take our weary waiting and form in us a readiness for renewal. Shape our hearts for healing, our minds for mending, and our souls for sharing. Let no weight of the moment prevent our remembering of your long reach of faithfulness cast over the whole creation. Still us enough to discover again your prayer rising in our praying, that we may be formed by Your love made known to us in Jesus Christ. By this, change us on the inside that our outer lives may more clearly reflect your will and way of mercy into the world. **Amen**.

HYMN*

***"Christ Is Made the Sure Foundation"*** NCH 400

PRAYER OF CONFESSIO[1] **(UNISON)***

**Loving God, form in me a space for healing and enter in anew. For too long I have clutched the past in ways that have prevented the possibility of moving forward. Boundaries of my own making have kept me resistant to your healing mercy. Definitions of the world's making have created divisions preventing the possibility of a new day, a new season, a new life. By Your mercy form me for a life of mercy and thanks. Lift every burden and release me from every long-rehearsed story holding me hostage to any narrative of hopelessness, hurt and fear. Grant instead a lightness of spirit forgiving me and freeing me to leap into a dance of delight beyond my wildest imagination. Amen**

PAUSE FOR REFLECTION

WORDS OF ASSURANCE

PASSING OF THE PEACE

**THE MESSAGE**

ANTHEM *THANKS BE TO GOD* G.F. HANDEL

SCRIPTURE READING

JEREMIAH 29:1; 4-7

LUKE 17:11-19

MORNING REFLECTION

"Mercy, Mercy Me"

HYMN*

***"Let Us Break Bread Together"*** NCH 330

**THE COMMUNION** BLUE BINDER

**THE THANKSGIVING**

SHARING OUR JOYS AND CONCERNS

CORAL CALL TO PRAYER:

*HEAR OUR PRAYER, O LORD* D. WELPTON

PRAYER OF THE PEOPLE ~

Lord's Prayer

**Our Father who art in heaven hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power and the glory, forever, Amen**

Choral Response to Prayer

*"Thou wilt keep him in perfect peace, whose mind is stayed on Thee."* Scottish Psalter, 1615

**THE DEPARTURE**

HYMN*

***"Carry the Light"*** INSERT

Benediction*

POSTLUDE

**ANNOUNCEMENTS:**

**A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:**

- Thank You Hadley Shannon for sharing your beautiful photos of the Blessing of the Animals!

**Bible Study**

Next meeting is Wednesday October 13th on Zoom – please let Pastor Jessica know if you'd like to join in!

**Church Street Sounds of the Season**

**TODAY** the performance will be Music-Comp at 3pm

**Midday Meditation**

**Monday ·Wednesday · Friday 12pm- 1pm**

Please join us in the sanctuary for quiet reflection. We'll have soothing music and meditation guides available.

**What is TAIZÉ?**

Created by and named after the Taizé (taa-ZAY) monastic community in France, which began in the 1940's; Taizé is a contemporary, repetitive, sung prayer set to simple music. The use of repetitive prayers has a long history in Christian spirituality (as well as many other faith traditions). Taizé prayers are unique in that they are fully ecumenical—they are adapted from core biblical texts and can be sung in various languages. The song should have no pre-determined length or number of repetitions—the intension is for the congregation to immerse itself in the simple harmonies leading to a contemplative state.